

7 Setting up a web server

A web server is a computer program that delivers (serves) content, such as web pages, using the Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP), over the World Wide Web or a Local Area Network. One of the most popular web servers for Ubuntu is Apache . If you want a quick MySQL and PHP enabled Apache2 server install LAMP.

7.1 Apache

The Apache HTTP Server is one of the most widely used web server. In 2009 it became the first web server software to surpass the 100 million web site milestone. Some of it's features include:

- Support for a variety of features, many implemented as compiled modules which extend the core functionality. The modules range from authentication schemes such as `mod_access`, `mod_auth`, `mod_digest`, and `mod_auth_digest` to server-side programming language support such as PHP, Python and Perl.

- SSL support (Using the `mod_ssl` module)

- Proxy module (Using the `mod_proxy` module)

- Serving compressed pages over HTTP.

- Configurable error messages.

- Virtual hosting: This allows one Apache installation to server many websites. For example one apache installation could simultaneously serve `www.example.com` and `www.example1.com`.

7.2 Installing Apache

You can install Apache from the command line using `apt-get` or `aptitude`. It can also be installed using `synaptics` package manager.

Installing it from the command line is simple:

```
$ sudo aptitude -r install apache
```

This will install Apache2 and recocomended packages to use with the Apache2 web server.

7.3 Configuring Apache

These are the different locations where the files associated with Apache web server are stored in your system:

`/etc/apache2`

A directory containing the configuration files for the Apache 2 Web server. The primary configuration file in this directory is the file `apache2.conf`

`/etc/apache2/conf.d`